

The Relationship Between Sports Achievement Motivation and Mental Toughness among Kabaddi Players

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ABSTRACT

The present study investigated the relationship between sports achievement motivation and mental toughness among Kabaddi players. A total of 100 Kabaddi players were selected for the study, 65 were males and 35 were females. Measuring sports Motivation, the Sports Achievement Motivation Test by Kamlesh (1990) was used, which is a self-evaluation questionnaire of 20 statements and mental toughness was measured using the mental toughness questionnaire developed by Dr. Alan Goldberg (1998), which was a 30-item questionnaire. The results showed that there is no significant positive relationship between sports achievement motivation and mental toughness was found among Kabaddi players. No significant gender differences in sports achievement motivation and mental toughness were found among Kabaddi players. Although, there was no significant positive relationship observed between the variables, a significant positive correlation emerged between sports achievement motivation and one dimension of mental toughness, which is rebound ability. Thus, this study provides support to the observation that as achievement motivation increases, rebound ability or resilience also increases amongst athletes. Hence, resilience being a protective factor, due attention could be paid to it in Kabaddi in psychological training and intervention as it would improve the athlete's will to succeed.

Keywords: Sports achievement motivation, mental toughness, psychological skills training.

INTRODUCTION

Sports play a significant role in an individual's life from the beginning of his or her life as an individual grows from his or her childhood days, where sports are a part of their education throughout their

schooling, and so every individual is a sportsperson in some way. In today's sports, the role of psychological factors in athletic performance is becoming more widely recognized, and it is widely

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accepted that somatic ability is not the only factor that determines victories. Physiological factors, technical ability, tactical knowledge, and mental state all play a part in sports performance (Purcell, Gwyther & Rice, 2019).

Professional and amateur athletes can benefit from sports psychology to help them deal with challenges, improve their performance, and achieve their goals. Sports psychology is vital for good performance in most sports; it may support all athletes in taming their performance, adapting to competitive pressures, overcoming injuries, maintaining an exercise routine, and enjoying their activity (Elmagd, 2016). Sports provide a lot of benefits and can have a big impact on people's life. Team sports promote one's health and well-being, as well as one's confidence and mental wellness. Sports assist the developing brain by stimulating reward pathways in the brain and increasing mood-boosting neurochemicals like dopamine levels. An increase in dopamine results in a sense of well-being and lowers the risk of anxiety and sadness (Godfrey, H. D. 2018).

Children and teenagers can benefit from sports in a variety of ways, including socially, emotionally, physically, and psychologically. They also provide an opportunity for youngsters to learn and practice in a competitive setting. Participating in team sports may be a fantastic tool for helping

youngsters grow and achieve in their daily lives and the future (Payne & Fogarty, 2008).

Indigenous games have their origins in a particular cultural group, community, or people. These games differ from traditional sports in that they are governed by international federations and follow strict rules. Agility, strength, balance, reflexes, hand-eye coordination, accuracy, strategy, intuition, and patience are just a few of the qualities required for success. Those abilities were acquired through games at a young age and retained through play into maturity.

Kabaddi is an Indian main contact sport. It is a popular sport in India, especially among village inhabitants. India has won gold in each of the four Asian Games in Kabaddi. Kabaddi which was once a rural sport in India has gained much in stature to become a priority sports discipline in India as well as a recognized Asian discipline. Its introduction to African countries as a showcase sport at the AFRO-ASIAN GAMES, held by India in 2002, marked a watershed moment in the game's new-century history. This rise of the game from a simple rustic status to an international sport, which has a time duration of 35 minutes with a 5-minute break in between (Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India, 2017).

Sport mental toughness is defined as an athlete's outstanding mental abilities (Gucciardi et al., 2009). Mental

toughness is the ability to manage well than your competitors with the multiple needs that sport places on performance in terms of competition, training, and lifestyle, as well as to be more reliable and top than our competitors in being resolute, purposeful, definite, and staying in control under pressure. Young athletes can be encouraged to be extroverted and develop social skills through sports. Teamwork, time management, and discipline are just a few of the vital skills that may be instilled through sports participation (Maslen, 2015).

Mental toughness was described by Clough et al. (2002), using the four C's. They claim that mental toughness is based on challenge, commitment, control, and confidence. While there is some variation in definitions, mental toughness appears to be linked to the effective exhibition of a set of psychological talents (Clough, Earle & Sewell, 2002). At the highest level of sports tournaments, beating the opposition with raw physical talent and games is difficult. Mental toughness and psychological strength are more important than skills in sports; hence mental preparation must be done in conjunction with physical preparation for impending competition (Patel, Pandey, Sarema, & Kalyanpur, 2011).

Goldberg (1998) classified mental toughness into five different types based on mental functioning at the time of competitive situations that are "The

ability to bounce back, the ability to deal with pressure, concentration, confidence, and motivation." "Rebound ability" refers to the mental ability to recover from setbacks and challenges experienced before and during a performance (Goldberg, 1998). "The ability to handle pressure is the mental capacity to deal with a variety of external and internal factors that can cause a sense of pressure" (Baric, 2011).

Motivation is the process of exciting action, maintaining activity in progress, and directing and shaping the pattern of activity through energy alternation within the organism's tissues. It is a modified form of "motive" that denotes desires, efforts, willpower, and motivations, among other things

Achievement Motivation is the endeavor to achieve victory and to be a goal concerned with an individual to attain achievement. It directs behavior in an activity that is praised and satisfying. Motivation as an awareness inspires an individual for any task/activity/goal. If we confine this discussion to games and a sport, the performance level is determined by various psychological and physiological factors (Schilling & Hyarhi, 2001). Atkinson (1964) defined achievement motivation as the inclination to Endeavour for attaining a goal. A specific motive is concerned with the attainment of a specific type of goal. Achievement motivation is centered on obtaining victory and realizing all of our

life goals. Motivation is crucial since it affects our lives daily. All of our actions, activities, attitudes, and beliefs are influenced by our inner desire to succeed. The present Study aimed to assess the mental toughness and sports achievement motivation (SAMT) of Kabaddi players and to analyze the relationship between sports achievement motivation and mental toughness.

METHODOLOGY

Sample collection

Non-parametric sampling methods were used. 100 Kabaddi Players (aged between 15 to 30 years) undergoing training in various sports centers in South India were selected based on purposive and snowball sampling methods. All athletes who fit the inclusion criteria were selected.

Psychometric Assessment Techniques

- **Mental Toughness (MT)**

The mental toughness questionnaire was developed by Dr. Alan Goldberg. This is 30 item questionnaires and there are only two responses for each question that is false or true. There are 5 sub-dimensions and each sub-dimension has 6 items. MT-R: Reboundability, MT-HP: Ability to handle pressure, MT-CN: Concentration, MT-CF: Confidence, and MT-M: Motivation.

- **Sports Achievement Motivation (SAMT)**

Achievement motivation when it

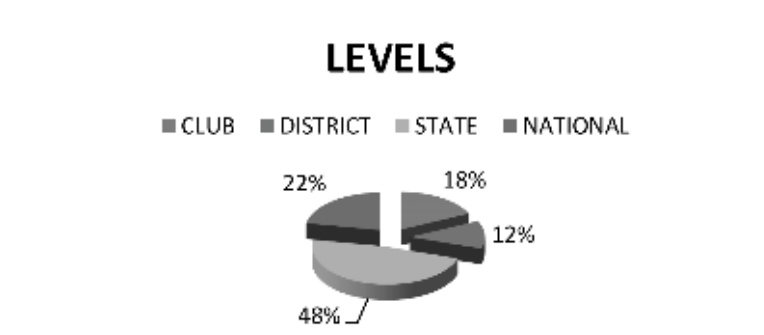
comes to sports, motivation refers to a player's willingness to approach a competition situation (Watson, 1982). The Sports Achievement Motivation Test (Kamlesh, 1990) is a 20-statement self-assessment questionnaire. This test's response result ranged from 0 to 40 in total. A maximum score of 2 and a minimum score of 0 are assigned to each statement. A key has been included with the scale to help evaluate the responses. In a test of twenty statements with response values ranging from 0 to 40, the SAMT has a test-retest reliability of 0.70. The validity SAMT with the athletes' real performance was calculated to be 0.55.

The statistical analysis was done to calculate the mean, standard deviation, inferential statistics of Spearman Rho, Mann Whitney U test by using SPSS, version 20. Confidence interval for the statistical significance given at $p < 0.05$.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The sample was compressed of 100 (65 males and 35 females) Kabaddi players from South India age ranges from 15 -30 years. The sample further included 22 National players, 48 State players, 12 District players, and 18 Club players. All the players were informed about the nature, aim, and their role in the study. Informed consent was obtained from the players enrolled in the subject selection. Figure 1 is depicting each participant's level of participation ranging from Club, District, State, and National levels.

Figure 1: Division in terms of the level of representation of the Kabaddi Players (N=100)



Variables	SAMT	MT	MT-R	MT-HP	MT-CN	MT-CF	MT-M
SAMT		0.178	0.203*	0.147	0.143	-0.017	-0.057
MT			0.667**	0.643**	0.664**	0.703**	0.361**
MT-R				0.333**	0.211*	0.331**	0.170
MT-HP					0.242*	0.330**	-.020*
MT-CN						0.43**	0.022
MT-CF							0.131
MT-M							

Table 1: Correlation co-efficient value (Spearman's rho) between Sports Achievement Motivation, and Mental Toughness amongst Kabaddi players (N=100)

SAMT: Sports Achievement Motivation Tool
 MT: Mental Toughness
 MT-R: Mental Toughness- Reboundability
 MT-HP: Mental Toughness- Handling pressure
 MT-CN: Mental Toughness-Concentration
 MT-CF: Mental Toughness-Confidence
 MT-M: Mental Toughness- Motivation

**Significant at 0.01 level (Two-tailed)

* Significant at 0.05 level (Two-tailed)

Table 1 shows the correlation coefficient value (Spearman's rho) between Sports Achievement Motivation and Mental Toughness amongst Kabaddi players indicating that the correlation coefficient of Sports Achievement motivation and Mental Toughness amongst Kabaddi players is 0.178, which is not significant. The correlation between co-efficient Achievement Motivation and rebound

ability is 0.203, which is significant at a 0.05 level of significance. This means there is a significant positive relationship between the variables. It signifies that, if there is an increase in achievement motivation then the athlete's rebound ability also increases. The correlation between co-efficient Sports Achievement Motivation and ability to handle pressure is 0.147 which is not significant. Further,

the correlation between co-efficient Sports Achievement Motivation and concentration is 0.143, which is not significant. Then the correlation between co-efficient Achievement Motivation and confidence is -0.017, which is not significant. Also the correlation between co-efficient Achievement Motivation and motivation is -0.057, which is not significant.

The results shown in Table 1 indicate that there is a significant positive correlation between one dimension of mental toughness which is rebound ability and achievement motivation ($r=0.203$, $p<0.05$) this means rebound ability increases achievement motivation also increase. However, there is no significant difference between the other dimensions of mental toughness and achievement motivation.

Table 2: Mann Whitney U test for Sports Achievement Motivation, and Mental Toughness.

Variables	MEAN RANK					
	Male	Female	U	W	Z	P
SAMT	49.51	52.34	1.1	3.21	-.5	.64
MT	49.09	53.11	1.1	3.2	-.7	.51
MT-R	50.78	49.97	1.12	1.74	-.14	.9
MT-HP	49.35	52.63	1.2	3.20	-.56	.6
MT-CN	48.5	54.23	1.01	3.2	-.96	.34
MT-CF	51.72	48.3	1.1	1.7	-.6	.5
MT-M	48.7	53.6	1.03	3.2	-.83	.4

Table 2 shows the results of the Mann-Whitney U test. The test was used to find out the gender difference among the Kabaddi players. The table shows there is no significant gender difference among the Kabaddi players in achievement motivation and mental toughness.

CONCLUSION

Finally, this research provides important insights into the relationship between sports achievement motivation and mental toughness among Kabaddi

players. While no substantial overall association was found between these characteristics, a notable positive correlation appeared, notably in the area of rebound ability. This association supports the idea that enhanced accomplishment motivation correlates with increased resilience, which contributes to a better understanding of the complex dynamics between psychological elements in sports performance. Furthermore, the study confirms the lack of substantial gender

discrepancies in sports accomplishment motivation and mental toughness among Kabaddi players, emphasizing the

significance of a comprehensive approach to athlete development.

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